



1. Mediterranean diet is rich in vegetables, fruits, whole grains, fish, olive oil, nuts, legumes and dairy
2. In Keto, nearly 80 per cent of calories consumed come from fat

says don't eat after sunset. Give the body a break to recover, rejuvenate and boost metabolism. Intermittent fasting success principles are based on Ayurveda," says Delhi-based preventive health practitioner, Dr Shikha Sharma, Founder of Nutri Health.

Under intermittent fasting you ideally fast for 16 hours a day and eat all your meals in an eight hour period. "You can start with 12-12, then 14-10 and then eventually 16-8. Not everything works for everyone. So you must try it out first," says Devgan. She says you don't need to do it every day. "Even if you do it for three days back-to-back and then stick to your normal schedule for the remaining four days, that will still get you benefits." However, she advises against diets where it's recommended that you eat all your calories in just one meal a day.

Sharma says that while intermittent fasting tells you when to eat, it doesn't tell you what to eat. "What you eat is 50 per cent of the success, 25 per cent is when you eat and balance is how you eat, the process, and of

course exercise." Sharma recommends having a lot of fibre in the diet and also mixed grains. "We consume too much wheat and rice in our diet. We need to have other grains such as ragi, jowar, bajra." For intermittent fasting, she recommends not eating after 7:30 pm.

Keto

The high-fat, low-carb diet that took the world by storm a few years ago with Halle Berry and Kim Kardashian swearing by it, is not recommended by most nutritionists. Keto or the Ketogenic diet is based on the premise that by significantly reducing your carbohydrate intake, you will force the body into a state of ketosis, where it will burn fat instead of carbohydrates for energy. If you follow Keto strictly, nearly 80 per cent of your calories will come from fat. "There is not enough research on the long-term impact of eating such a fat diet, especially on Indian bodies where we are already prone to lifestyle diseases," says Devgan, warning against Keto. Agrees Sharma, "In Keto you are over-

stressing your liver and kidney. It was never meant to be a weight loss diet."

Keto is also extremely difficult to follow because it involves cutting out almost all carbohydrates. That means giving up or limiting conventionally healthy foods like fruits, whole grains and vegetables.

Paleo/ Caveman Diet / Pegan

The Paleo or the Caveman Diet typically includes lean meats, fish, fruits, vegetables, nuts and seeds—foods that in the past could be obtained by hunting and gathering. It does not include dairy, grains and legumes. Popular with Hollywood stars such as Uma Thurman and Megan Fox, the Paleo diet has now been fused with vegan principles and is called Pegan. So no meats or animal products, just fruits, vegetables, nuts and seeds. Though Devgan is not in favour of any fad diet, she says since Paleo has a lot of high fibre, if you have to try out a fad diet, then "may be Paleo is not too bad". **BT**

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